

# SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

September 29, 2026 | 04:11 PM ET

## MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)

VIX 16.1 (+0.4 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +0.3% | IWM 20d -4.0% | IWM/SPY trend -4.3%

Leaders: Technology (+5.9%), Comms (+0.5%), Healthcare (-0.6%)

## Setup Grades

| A - Prime Setup (0) | B - Building (1) | C - Early Stage (2) |
|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|
|                     | HNGE             | DHX                 |
|                     |                  | LIND                |

## All Watchlist Setups

| Gr | Ticker | Company           | Theme                | Mkt Cap | Price   | Pivot   | To Pivot | RS/SPY | Vol Dry | RS Hi |
|----|--------|-------------------|----------------------|---------|---------|---------|----------|--------|---------|-------|
| B  | HNGE   | Hinge Health, Inc | Employer Health Bene | \$7.68B | \$95.17 | \$97.95 | 2.9%     | +9.1   | YES     | YES   |
| C  | DHX    | DHI Group, Inc.   | AI/Tech Talent Deman | \$0.21B | \$4.88  | \$5.19  | 6.4%     | +25.7  | YES     | no    |
| C  | LIND   | Lindblad Expediti | Luxury Experience Tr | \$2.05B | \$31.27 | \$31.42 | 0.5%     | +14.2  | YES     | no    |

| VCP BASE ANALYSIS                          |                    |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| BASE STRUCTURE                             |                    |
| Pivot Price                                | \$97.95            |
| % to Pivot                                 | 2.9%               |
| Days in Base                               | 20                 |
| Tightness                                  | 1.83 Good          |
| 52W Hi Prox                                | 97.2%              |
| VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP) |                    |
| Wk1 (recent)                               | 1569k <            |
| Wk2                                        | 2235k <            |
| Wk3 (oldest)                               | 1823k              |
| Coil Strength                              | 13.9% from peak    |
| RELATIVE STRENGTH                          |                    |
| RS vs SPY (12W)                            | +9.1%              |
| RS Line New Hi                             | YES - Early Leader |
| Above 50MA                                 | YES                |
| Above 200MA                                | YES                |
| FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT                      |                    |
| Mkt Cap                                    | \$7.68B            |
| Float                                      | 50M sh             |
| P/E (TTM)                                  | 11.6               |
| Fwd P/E                                    | 31.1               |
| Rev Growth                                 | 53.0%              |
| Short %                                    | 7.8%               |
| Inst. Own                                  | -                  |
| Target Pr.                                 | \$108.19           |

| ENTRY TRIGGER                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Close above \$97.95 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (2.7M+ shares)                                                 |
| Target: \$115.00 (measured move: base depth of ~18% projects 18% from pivot; aligns with Street target of \$108) |
| Stop: \$93.00 (base low and 50-day MA support confluence)                                                        |

| CATALYST INTELLIGENCE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EARNINGS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| November 03 - Street consensus ~\$0.75 EPS on ~\$195M revenue. Trailing PE of 11.6x on TTM EPS of \$8.22 reflects a strong profitability inflection-this is rare for digital health at scale. 53% YoY revenue growth with 84.5% gross margins and 19% operating margins demonstrates operating leverage. Recent quarters show beat-and-raise pattern as enterprise contract renewals and new logo wins accelerate. Guidance trend has been raised; watch for continued enterprise bookings momentum.                                                                        |
| BUSINESS & POSITION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Hinge Health is the leading digital musculoskeletal (MSK) clinic, offering AI-powered virtual physical therapy and chronic pain management solutions sold primarily to self-insured employers and health plans. The company has established category leadership in a \$100B+ MSK care market, displacing expensive surgeries and in-person PT visits with sensor-enabled exercise therapy and health coaching delivered via app.                                                                                                                                            |
| FACTOR & THEME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Taps into the secular shift toward value-based digital health, employer benefits cost containment, and AI-enhanced clinical care-themes that remain in early innings despite 2021-22 digital health washout. Healthcare sector is middle-of-pack (-0.6% 20d) but HNGE's +9.1% RS vs SPY signals stock-specific institutional accumulation decoupled from sector drag; peer TDOC stabilization and OSCR strength suggest digital health sentiment is quietly re-rating.                                                                                                      |
| NEWS FLOW                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| No major news in last 30 days indicates quiet accumulation phase rather than headline-driven chase. Key forward catalysts include potential large employer contract announcements heading into 2027 benefits enrollment season (Oct-Nov) and possible expansion into Medicare Advantage channel. Industry read-through: UNH and large payors increasingly partnering with digital MSK vendors to reduce surgical costs-HNGE is the scaled winner in this RFP cycle. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) in 35 days.                                                            |
| INSTITUTIONAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| The volume dry-up (1.57M 2.24M 1.82M with today at 0.78x avg) combined with price holding within 3% of highs is textbook quiet institutional accumulation-large funds are building positions without moving price. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed, but \$7.7B market cap and 84% gross margins make this squarely institutional-grade. No insider buying in last 60 days is neutral given recent IPO dynamics (May 2025 IPO lockup considerations). Short interest at 7.8% with 2.6 days-to-cover provides modest squeeze fuel if breakout occurs. |
| KEY RISK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Thesis invalid on a daily close below \$93.00 (base low / 50-day MA zone), or if Q3 guidance is cut due to enterprise sales cycle elongation. Bear case: forward PE of 31x on \$3.06 FY EPS assumes continued 40%+ growth-any deceleration in enterprise bookings would compress multiple rapidly given digital health's historical de-rating pattern.                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

Strong VCP structure with RS line at new high, tight base (1.83), and vol dry-up into a pivot only 2.9% away-textbook accumulation signature. Healthcare is not leading but HNGE's relative strength demonstrates stock-specific alpha. However, vol\_w1 < vol\_w3 but vol\_w2 > vol\_w3 shows imperfect stair-step contraction (vol\_dryup\_strict: false), and earnings catalyst is 35 days out-too distant for A-grade immediacy. Strongest disconfirming argument: digital health sector re-rating may stall if macro shifts to risk-off given high forward multiple. Conviction: Medium-High.

HNGE — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$97.95 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



| VCP BASE ANALYSIS                          |                 |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| BASE STRUCTURE                             |                 |
| Pivot Price                                | \$5.19          |
| % to Pivot                                 | 6.4%            |
| Days in Base                               | 17              |
| Tightness                                  | 2.78 Fair       |
| 52W Hi Prox                                | 94.0%           |
| VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP) |                 |
| Wk1 (recent)                               | 221k <          |
| Wk2                                        | 360k <          |
| Wk3 (oldest)                               | 308k            |
| Coil Strength                              | 28.2% from peak |
| RELATIVE STRENGTH                          |                 |
| RS vs SPY (12W)                            | +25.7%          |
| RS Line New Hi                             | no              |
| Above 50MA                                 | YES             |
| Above 200MA                                | YES             |
| FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT                      |                 |
| Mkt Cap                                    | \$0.21B         |
| Float                                      | 30M sh          |
| P/E (TTM)                                  | 162.7           |
| Fwd P/E                                    | 21.7            |
| Rev Growth                                 | -2.1%           |
| Short %                                    | 0.9%            |
| Inst. Own                                  | -               |
| Target Pr.                                 | \$6.75          |

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$5.19 on volume >175% of 20-day avg (400K+ shares)

Target: \$6.50 (prior resistance zone; aligns with Street target \$6.75)

Stop: \$4.40 (base low and 200-day MA support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 09

RS line NOT at new high despite +25.7% vs SPY, base\_tight of 2.78 is loose, revenue declining -2.1% YoY, and 6.4% to pivot leaves room for base to fail. Vol dry-up exists but structure needs tightening. Tech hiring recovery theme is speculative without clear catalyst in next 2 weeks. Monitor for RS line breakout and base compression before upgrade. Conviction: Low.

DHX — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$5.19 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



LIND

\$31.27

C EARLY STAGE

Lindblad Expeditions Holdings Inc.

Pivot \$31.42 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +14.2%

\$2.05B Cap | 49M Float

Adventure Cruise & Expedition Travel | Theme: Luxury Experience Travel Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.96

| VCP BASE ANALYSIS                          |                |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------|
| BASE STRUCTURE                             |                |
| Pivot Price                                | \$31.42        |
| % to Pivot                                 | 0.5%           |
| Days in Base                               | 4              |
| Tightness                                  | 4.96 Fair      |
| 52W Hi Prox                                | 89.3%          |
| VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP) |                |
| Wk1 (recent)                               | 830k <         |
| Wk2                                        | 1056k <        |
| Wk3 (oldest)                               | 914k           |
| Coil Strength                              | 9.2% from peak |
| RELATIVE STRENGTH                          |                |
| RS vs SPY (12W)                            | +14.2%         |
| RS Line New Hi                             | no             |
| Above 50MA                                 | YES            |
| Above 200MA                                | YES            |
| FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT                      |                |
| Mkt Cap                                    | \$2.05B        |
| Float                                      | 49M sh         |
| P/E (TTM)                                  | -              |
| Fwd P/E                                    | 55.4           |
| Rev Growth                                 | 18.6%          |
| Short %                                    | 10.6%          |
| Inst. Own                                  | -              |
| Target Pr.                                 | \$35.50        |

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$31.42 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (1.2M+ shares)

Target: \$35.00 (52-week high; Street target \$35.50)

Stop: \$28.50 (20-day MA and recent consolidation low)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 03

Proximity to pivot is excellent (0.5%) but base\_tight of 4.96 is far too loose for VCP quality, days\_in\_base of only 4 is insufficient consolidation, RS line not at new high, and Consumer Cyclical sector is lagging. High beta (2.22) and 10.6% short interest create volatility risk in a large-cap-led, IWM-weak tape. Base needs 2-3 more weeks to tighten before consideration. Conviction: Low.

LIND — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$31.42 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

